General Breaks

Silence — 4 Beats of Silence
4 fingers

1																

Double Silence — 8 Beats of Silence
two hands show 4 fingers

1																
2																

Triple Silence — 12 Beats of Silence
like "Double Silence" one hand upside down

1																
2																
3																

Quad Silence — 16 Beats of Silence
like "Double Silence" both hands upside down

1																
2																
3																
4																

Continue for One Bar — Continue 4 Beats
draw a horizontal line in the air with one finger

1	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

Continue for Two Bars — Continue 8 Beats
like "continue for one bar" with both hands

1	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
2	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

Continue for Three Bars — Continue 12 Beats
like "continue for two bars" and then "continue for one bar" in the opposite direction

1	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
2	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
3	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

Continue for Four Bars — Continue 16 Beats
like "continue for two bars" and then again in the opposite direction

1	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
2	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
3	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
4	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

Boom Break
Show an explosion away from your body with both hands

1	E															

Eight Up — from soft to loud
both hands move up while fingers shaking

1	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
2	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E

Eight Down — from loud to soft
both hands move down while fingers shaking

1	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
2	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E

Karla Break — from soft to loud
rabbit ears OR finger pistol shooting up

1	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
2	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
3	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
4	E															

Oi/Ua Break
... "oi": two arms crossing, with OK-sign
... "ua": two fists, knuckles hit each other

E				[E E E]				E				*shout ...*			

Cat Break
claws to left and right

m				i				a				u			

from high to low sound

Wolf Break
wolf's ears and teeth

1	S		S		A		S	S	S		S		A			S
2	S		S		A			S	S		S		A			
3	S		S		A		S	S	S		S		A			E
4	E		E		E		E		E			a	u	-	-	-

< a-u = like a howling wolf

Democracy Break
shout with your hands forming a funnel

1	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
2	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
3	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
4	This		is		what		demo		cracy				looks		like	
5	E		E		E		E	E		E	E		E		E	
6	This		is		what		demo		cracy				looks		like	
7	E		E		E		E	E		E	E		E		E	
8	This		is		what		demo		cracy				looks		like	
9	This		is		what		demo		cracy				looks		like	
10	This		is		what		demo		cracy				looks		like	
11	E			E			E			E			E			

from soft to loud

from soft to loud

Laughing Break
fingers move up coners of your mouth

ha		ha		ha		ha		ha		ha		haaaa				

from high to low sound

laughter

Star Wars Break
Move flat hand from top to bottom of face

1	ms				ms				ms				ls			hs
2	ms				ls			hs	ms							

Progressive Break
5 fingers and other hand grabbing thumb
(can be inverted by showing the sign upside down)

1	E				E				E				E			
2	E		E		E		E		E		E		E		E	
3	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E

Progressive Karla
rabbit ears OR finger pistol, the other hand is grabbing the thumb

1	E				E				E				E			
2	E		E		E		E		E		E		E		E	
3	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
4	E															

Clave
Point your thumb and index finger up as if indicating a distance of about 10 cm between them

E			E			E				E		E				

Clave inverted
Like "Clave", but with the two fingers pointing down

		E		E				E			E			E		

Yala Break
all fingertips of one hand gather and shake wrist

E		E				E		E				E				

Double Yala Break
Yala Break sign with both hands and crossed arms

E	E		E	E		E		E	E		E	E		E		

Dance Break
Show a > with your index+middle finger and move it horizontally in front of your eyes.

E-	very			bo	-	dy		dance				now				

Everybody sings

After the break, everyone continues to play walking around dancing randomly for a while.

Hard Core Break
Both hands in the air, with index and pinky fingers pointing up. Back of the hands facing away from you.

1-3	I		I		I		I		I		I		I		E	E	E
4	E		I		I		I		E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	
5-7	E		I		e		I		e		I		e		E	E	
8	E		I		e		I		E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	
-11	E		e		E		e		E		e		E		E	E	
12	E		e		E		e		E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	
13-15	E		E		E		E		E		E		E		E	E	
16	E		E		E		E		E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E	

x3

x3

x3

I = Agogô plays low e = everyone except Surdos
13-16: Agogô plays high

4 times from soft to loud

Hold one arm vertically in front of your body and move the other up along the arm

When any break or sequence of breaks is shown followed by this sign, it should be played 4 times, starting very quietly and getting louder each time.

Tamborim Stroke

Make a circle with your index finger and thumb, like "OK"

Everyone plays the line of the tamborim once

Play another instrument

Hold both hands in front of your face, and wave your arms to cross each other

Show this sign followed by the sign of an instrument to make everyone play the line of that instrument.

Switch Call/Response

Point with both index fingers forward and wave your arms to cross each other.

Calling and responding instruments switch roles. Only works in Call+Response breaks, for example Wolf Break or Funk Break 1.

In a loop

Hold one arm vertically in front of your body and make a wave over it with the other hand

When any break or sequence of breaks is shown followed by this sign, it should be repeated continuously until the maestra instructs to play something else.

Storming Break

show the arm as a measure with the other hand on ellbow don't make a fist

chosen instrument section plays sixteenths with volume indicated by maestra

if you can't stand it anymore: scream

Alerting / Magic Wand Break

show your flat hand and hit it with stick

Stop the Surdos. Give a sign for when the Surdos should hit once, by hitting the stick on the hand in the air. It's easier to follow if you paint a small loop in the air with your stick, just before hitting. Start with just one hit every four beats, then add more.

Chaos Break

Point with index finger at temple

Everyone plays something chaotic, getting louder and louder. No Counting in!

Again

Hit with flat hand on forehead

Repeat the last break (combination)

Improvisation

Point at your nose and at the sambista who can play freely

Show all others what they should do in the meantime, so the length of the impro part is defined

Notation

Call-Response

E	Everybody
A	All others
S	Surdos
ls	Low Surdo
ms	Mid Surdo
hs	High Surdo
R	Repinique
sn	Snare
T	Tamborim

Strokes

x	hit the skin with a stick
.	hit the skin softly with a stick
hd	hit the skin with your hand
sil	silent stroke: hit the skin with a stick, while the other hand rests on the skin
0	put your hand on the skin to dampen the sound
fl	flare: multiple hit with rebounding stick
ri	hit the rim with a stick
w	hit the skin with a whippy stick (Tamborim stick), if not available hit the rim
h	Agogô: high bell
l	Agogô: low bell